Telesat Canada

Notes to the 2019 Consolidated Financial Statements - (Continued)
(all amounts in thousands of Canadian dollars, except where otherwise noted)

29. SHARE-BASED COMPENSATION PLANS (cont.)

The weighted average fair value of the stock options granted during 2019 was $12.84 (2018 – weighted average fair value of the stock options and restricted share units was $13.37). There were no restricted share units granted in 2019.

30. EMPLOYEE BENEFIT PLANS

The expenses included on the consolidated statements of income (loss) and the consolidated statements of comprehensive income (loss) were as follows:

	Pension plans			Other post-employment benefit plans		
Years ended December 31,	**2019**	**2018**	**2017**	**2019**	**2018**	**2017**
Consolidated statements of income (loss)						
Operating expenses	$ 6,198	$ 6,345	$ 6,239	$ 116	$ 276	$ 243
Interest expense	$ 524	$ 658	$ 650	$ 815	$ 830	$ 861
Consolidated statements of comprehensive income (loss)						
Actuarial (gains) losses on employee benefit plans	$ (3,325)	$ (4,555)	$ 3,761	$ 2,191	$ (3,200)	$ 1,410

In October 2013, the Company ceased to allow new employees to join certain defined benefit plans, except under certain circumstances, and commenced a defined contribution pension plan for new employees.

The Company made contributions of $1.2 million for various defined contribution arrangements during 2019 (December 31, 2018 — $0.9 million).

The Company's funding policy is to make contributions to its defined benefit pension funds based on actuarial cost methods as permitted and required by pension regulatory bodies. Contributions reflect actuarial assumptions concerning future investment returns, salary projections and future service benefits. Plan assets are represented primarily by Canadian and foreign equity securities, fixed income instruments and short-term investments.

The Company provides certain health care and life insurance benefits for some of its retired employees and their dependents. Participants are eligible for these benefits generally when they retire from active service and meet the eligibility requirements for the pension plan. These benefits are funded primarily on a pay-as-you-go basis, with the retiree generally paying a portion of the cost through contributions, deductibles and coinsurance provisions.

The balance sheet obligations, distributed between pension and other post-employment benefits, included in other long-term liabilities (Note 23) were as follows:

As at December 31,	**2019**	**2018**
Pension benefits	$ 8,566	$ 10,905
Other post-employment benefits	23,508	21,330
Accrued benefit liabilities	$ 32,074	$ 32,235